SIDSSA 24

17-19 MARCH

Century City Conference Centre

Sustainable Infrastructure Development Symposium South Africa

Post Show Report

Quality infrastructure for development, recovery and inclusive growth.

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REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

INFRASTRUCTURE South Africa

H.E. Cyril Ramaphosa

President, The Republic of South Africa

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A MESSAGE FROM THE MINISTER

public works & infrastructure
Department:
Public Works and Infrastructure
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

Hon. Sihle Zikalala

Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure
The Republic of South Africa

In South Africa, infrastructure serves as a pillar of economic growth. We at the Ministry have been working with Infrastructure South Africa to coordinate and ensure that we integrate all infrastructure projects in a way that is effective and sustainable. As such, the purpose of this symposium has been to identify areas of priority in infrastructure and ensure that we integrate efforts to implement those priorities.

Infrastructure development plays a key role in ensuring fast economic growth and alleviating poverty in South Africa. The economy needs reliable infrastructure to connect supply chains and efficiently move goods and services across borders. Infrastructure connects households across metropolitan areas to higher quality opportunities for employment, healthcare and education. Furthermore, over and above the new types of needed infrastructure is a big change in how projects are financed.

It is clear that projects are becoming more complex. There is not a one-size-fits-all form of financing for them. Therefore, the level of private engagement will depend on market and business opportunities, and it is my hope that this symposium will continue to catalyse public and private sector interaction to gazette infrastructure development in our country.

SIDSSA 2024 served as a valuable platform to enable the deployment of investment necessary for our infrastructure targets. This will be central to achieving our development goals and opening up opportunities to create projects that support the wellbeing of our population.

A MESSAGE FROM THE ORGANISERS

INFRASTRUCTURE South Africa

Mameetse Masemola

Acting Head

Infrastructure South Africa

Infrastructure development is a fundamental sector for all nations and their economies to drive growth and stimulate social development. Few industries are as important to meeting the standards of achievement as infrastructure.

We are therefore extremely proud of the success of this symposium, which has attracted a wide array of delegates from the highest reaches of government who have gathered to drive connectivity and cultivate collaboration throughout Africa's infrastructure space. Through inspiring discussions, open dialogue and accelerated delivery of projects, SIDSSA 2024 has delivered on its promise to gazette opportunities for investing in infrastructure for stakeholders in the region.

South Africa is a country that needs infrastructure to address social disparities, transform the economy, create much-needed jobs and drive the region's economic development. The basic physical systems of a business, region or nation is dependent on the best practices of the sector and its managers.

Therefore, we express our gratitude to all delegates and participants who have showed great enthusiasm and worked very hard to make this symposium a success. SIDSSA 2024 could not have been successful without the dedicated involvement of the South African government, Infrastructure South Africa and the Investment and Infrastructure Office under the Presidency.

The single-track focus of this symposium will surely stimulate connectivity and goodwill and leave a lasting impression on attendees in their efforts to promote the sustainable development of infrastructure throughout Africa.

PRESIDENT, MINISTERS & VIPS

H.E. Cyril Ramaphosa - President, South Africa

H.E. Paul Mashatile
Deputy President
South Africa

Hon. Sihle Zikalala
Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure
South Africa

Hon. Bernice Swarts
Deputy Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure
South Africa

Hon. Kenny Morolong
Deputy Minister in the Presidency
South Africa

Hon. Sindisiwe Chikunga
Minister of Transport
South Africa

Hon. Lisa Mangcu
Deputy Minister of Transport
South Africa

Hon. Patricia de Lille
Minister of Tourism
South Africa

Hon. Philly Mapulane
Deputy Minister of Communications and Digital Technologies
South Africa

Hon. Thembi Nkadimeng
Minister of Cooperative Governance and Traditional Affairs
South Africa

Hon. Tertuis Simmers
Provincial Minister of Infrastructure in the Western Cape

Hon. Mmamoloko Kubayi
Minister of Housing
South Africa

Hon. Senzo Mchunu
Minister of Water and Sanitation
South Africa

Hon. Mxolisi Dukwana
Premier of the Free State Province

Hon. Nomusa Dube-Ncube
Premier of KwaZulu-Natal

Hon. Sekou M. Kromah
Minister of Posts and Telecommunications
Liberia

Hon. Panyaza Lesufi
Premier of Gauteng

Hon. Chief Ndlaluhlaza Ndwandwe
Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure
Eswatini

Hon. Lebona Lephema
Minister of Local Government Chieftainship, Home Affairs and Police Lesotho

Hon. Winston Chitando
Minister of Local Government and Public Works
Zimbabwe

Hon. Billy Rangasamy
Minister of Land and Housing,
Seychelles

Hon. Don Pascual Ondo Nze Oyana
Minister of Public Works, Housing and Town Planning
Equatorial Guinea

LAUNCH OF THE SOUTH AFRICAN CONSTRUCTION BOOK

The South African Construction Book was officially launched at SIDSSA 2024 on March 19. Providing a comprehensive overview of the opportunities for investment in the country's infrastructure, the book details projects ready for procurement in South Africa's infrastructure sector.

The Construction Book has the primary purpose of providing the infrastructure projects expected for market in the 2024/2025 fiscal year for stakeholders and investors. The forward-looking projects will be procured in the new fiscal year and includes over 150 projects with a total accumulated budget of R158 billion.

Through the Construction Book, potential investors are granted first-hand insight into opportunities across the economic spectrum. The book makes it easier to invest, providing private sector investors with the information they need to make informed decisions in the market.

SCAN HERE
TO DOWNLOAD
THE CONSTRUCTION BOOK

OR VISIT
WWW.SIDSSA.ORG.ZA/CONSTRUCTION-BOOK

LAUNCH OF SOUTH AFRICA'S 12 INFRASTRUCTURE PRIORITIES

Twelve major infrastructure projects were launched during SIDSSA 2024 with the aim of driving private and public sector-led development in South Africa. The projects span the transport, storage and communication; electricity, gas and water; community, social and personal services; mining and quarrying; and agriculture, forestry and fishing sectors, and fall under South Africa's 2024/2025 infrastructure pipeline.

The country's first LNG import terminal at Richards Bay aims to import 2 million tonnes of liquid gas per year. The long-term concession for the project was awarded by the government to terminal operator Vopak in January.

A capacity expansion initiative at the Durban Container Terminal Pier 1 will see the terminal's capacity expand from 0.2 million twenty-foot equivalent units (TEUs) to 1.8 million TEUs, while a new berth (A100) for liquid bulk will be constructed to handle imported LNG at the Port of East London.

Project Ukuvuzelela is a transnational, high-capacity rail corridor for automotive volumes, due for completion in 2025. The project involves upgrading the rail line from the provinces of Gauteng to the Eastern Cape and will serve to take pressure off the KwaZulu-Natal corridor and the Port of Durban as the sole port for imports and exports in the area.

In the community, social and personal services sector, the South African government will also launch an infrastructure strategy aimed at refurbishing health facilities throughout South Africa. Meanwhile, the Department of Public Works and Infrastructure has laid out plans to improve school building and education-related infrastructure in South Africa, charting a way towards increasing access to the internet and libraries for schoolchildren throughout the country.

In a bid to combat South Africa's ongoing energy crisis, the country's state-owned oil company, PetroSA, announced plans in March 2023 to build a network of gas-fired power plants in Mossel Bay. Furthermore, the country's parastatal electricity utility Eskom's proposal to build a Tubatse Pumped Hydro Storage project with a generation capacity of 1.5 GW received the green light from the Department of Mineral Resources and Energy in 2022.

Phase 2 of the Rooiwal WasteWater Works will involve upgrading the plant's treatment capacity by 50 million litres per day of wastewater, coupled with the desilting of sludge at the Leeukraal dam, which will enable the facility to function more efficiently while producing drinking water that meets national standards. Meanwhile, the proposed infrastructure upgrade to the Amathole Water bulk supply augmentation is set to gazette progress on the municipalities water scheme project.

Finally, multi-billion-dollar Special Economic Zones (SEZs) in the municipalities of Nkomazi and Namakwa are expected to significantly stimulate economic activity, industrial development, trade and job creation in the Mpumalanga and Northern Cape provinces, respectively.

EXIT
SPEAKER

EVENT STATS

1410
Total Attendees

57
Speakers

27
Countries represented

82
Media attendance

COUNTRIES REPRESENTED

- AUSTRALIA
- BRAZIL
- CAMEROON
- CHINA
- CONGO
- DENMARK
- ESWATINI
- EQUATORIAL GUINEA
- FRANCE
- GERMANY
- GHANA
- INDONESIA
- LESOTHO
- LIBERIA
- MALAWI
- MOZAMBIQUE
- NETHERLANDS
- RWANDA
- SEYCHELLES
- SOUTH AFRICA
- TUNISIA
- TURKEY
- UGANDA
- UNITED KINGDOM
- UNITED STATES
- ZAMBIA
- ZIMBABWE

PR AND COMMUNICATIONS

2,290
Articles Shared

R51 million
Total PR Value

443 million
Total Communications Reach

108 million
Editorial Reach

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public works & infrastructure
Department:
Public Works and Infrastructure
REPUBLIC OF SOUTH AFRICA

IMPLEMENTING PARTNERS

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ASSOCIATION PARTNERS

South African Council for the Architectural Profession

African Energy Chamber

MEDIA PARTNERS

PROGRAMME

Sunday – 17 March 2024

14:00 – 17:00 **Masterclass on Sustainable Infrastructure Development**
In collaboration with the National School of Government

Focus on: Infrastructure investment planning, building state capacity and capability to deliver aggressive infrastructure build programme; closing infrastructure investment gap.

Speakers:
- **Hon. Sihle Zikalala,** Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure, South Africa
- **Dr. Nthabiseng Moleko,** Development Economist & Senior Lecturer, Stellenbosch University
- **Malusi Shezi,** CEO, Construction Education and Training Authority
- **Cayley Green,** Principal Professional Officer, City of Cape Town
- **Mapatane Kgomo,** CEO, Municipal Infrastructure Support Agent
- **Dr. Harry Malila,** Director-General, Western Cape Government

Monday – 18 March 2024

09:00 – 11:00 **Leaders Meeting**
Hosted by:
- **Hon. Sihle Zikalala,** Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure, South Africa

Supported by:
- **Hon. Thembi Nkadimeng,** Minister of Cooperative Governance and Traditional Affairs, South Africa
- **Hon. Patricia de Lille,** Minister of Tourism, South Africa
- **Hon. Sindisiwe Chikunga,** Minister of Transport, South Africa
- **Hon. Bernice Swartz,** Deputy Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure, South Africa
- **Hon. Kenny Morolong,** Deputy Minister in the Presidency, South Africa
- **Hon. Lisa Mangcu,** Deputy Minister of Transport
- **Hon. Philly Mapulane,** Deputy Minister of Communications and Digital Technologies
- **Hon. Mxolisi Dukwana,** Premier of the Free State Province
- **Hon. Nomusa Dube-Ncube,** Premier of KwaZulu-Natal
- **Mameetse Masemola,** Head, Infrastructure South Africa
- **Sekou M. Kromah,** Minister of Posts and Telecommunications, Liberia
- **Chief Ndlaluhlaza Ndwandwe,** Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure, Eswatini
- **Lebona Lephema,** Minister of Local Government, Chieftainship, Home Affairs and Police, Lesotho
- **Winston Chitando,** Minister of Local Government and Public Works, Zimbabwe
- **Billy Rangasamy,** Minister of Land and Housing, Seychelles
- **Don Pascual Ondo Nze Oyana,** Minister of Public Works, Housing and Town Planning, Equatorial Guinea

13:00 – 16:00	**Parallel Event** Pre-Symposium Networking Luncheon **Venue:** Century City Convention Center
14:00	**Media Briefing** **Facilitated by Hon. Kenny Morolong,** Deputy Minister in the Presidency, South Africa **Progress updates on:** • Gazetted strategic integrated projects • Infrastructure fund pipeline • Project preparation funding allocation **Announcements:** • Launch of the construction book • Signing of Heads of Agreement • Unveiling of Top 12 Infrastructure Priorities for 2024/2025 • Signings
16:00	**Official Exhibition Opening & Walkthrough** • **Opened by Hon. Sihle Zikalala,** Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure, South Africa
19:00	**Stakeholder Dinner** **Hosted by:** • **Hon. Sihle Zikalala,** Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure, South Africa • **Hon. Paul Mashatile,** Deputy President, South Africa

Tuesday – 19 March 2024

07:00 – 08:00	**Breakfast and Media Interviews**
09:00	**Welcome Remarks** **Alan Richard Winde,** Premier of the Western Cape
09:15	**Opening Address** **Hon. Sihle Zikalala,** Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure, South Africa
09:45	**Keynote Address** **H.E. Cyril Ramaphosa,** President, South Africa
10:30	**Announcement of Top 12 Infrastructure Priorities & Launch of the Construction Book**
11:00	**High-Level Ministerial Panel Discussion**
11:45	**Signing Ceremony**
12:30	**Lunch**
12:30	**President Meet and Greet with Sponsors**
12:30	**Fireside Chat: Leading Sustainable Cannabis Production** **Doron Isaacs,** CEO, Karoo Bioscience
13:00	**Fireside Chat: Special Economic Zones** • **Themba Koza,** Acting CEO, COEGA • **Bheka Zulu,** CEO, Tshwane Automotive SEZ • **Stieneke Jensma,** COO, Industrial Zones Program, IDC • **Alvino Wildschutt-Prins,** Program Manager, Infrastructure Pipeline Development & Management, Infrastructure South Africa
13:30	**Fireside Chat: National Spatial Development Framework** • **Clinton Heinmann,** Deputy Director General for Spatial Planning and Land Use Management, Department of Agriculture, Land Reform and Rural Development
	Breakout Sessions
14:00 – 15:30	**Session A:** **Policy Perspective:** Investing in Water Infrastructure for Universal Access and in Support of a Strong, Inclusive Economy

Moderator: Zodwa Mbele, CFO, Development Bank of Southern Africa

Panellists:
- **Hon. Senzo Mchunu,** Minister of Water and Sanitation
- **Mxolisi Dukwana,** Premier of the Free State
- **Dr. Lester Goldman,** CEO, Water Institute of Southern Africa
- **Dr. Valeri Naidoo,** Executive Manager, Water Research Commission
- **Alex Simalabwi,** CEO and Executive Secretary, Global Water Partnership Southern & Africa Coordination
- **Dexter James King,** Commercial Lead: Southern & East Africa, HDF Energy South Africa
- **Percy Sechemane,** CEO, Trans-Caledon Tunnel Authority (TCTA)

Session B:
Money Matters: Financing Municipal Bulk Infrastructure

Moderator: Tsepiso Makwetla, SABC

Panellists:
- **Hon. Thembi Nkadimeng,** Minister of Cooperative Governance and Traditional Affairs
- **Mike Salawou,** Director of the Infrastructure and Urban Development Department, African Development Bank Group
- **Alastair Herbertson,** Managing Director, Emerging Africa Infrastructure Fund (Ninety-One)
- **Malijeng Ngqaleni,** Deput Director-General for Intergovernmental Relations, National Treasury
- **Mojabeng Manthata,** Head: Municipal Sectors – Cities, Waterboards and Economic Zones, DBSA Coverage Division
- **Sean Philips,** Director General, Department of Water and Sanitation

Session C:
Big Infrastructure Wins: Unpacking the Top 12 Project Priorities

Moderator: Clement Manyathela, Radio 702

Panellists:
- **Hon. Sihle Zikalala,** Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure
- **Mameetse Masemola,** Head of ISA, Infrastructure South Africa
- **Wayne Peterson,** Director: Transport and Infrastructure, WSP
- **Catherine-Candice Koffman,** Group Executive Project Preparation, Development Bank of Southern Africa

Session D:
Policy Perspective: Making Affordable Housing and Infrastructure Accessible for All

Moderator: Neville Chainee, Head of Department: Strategy, Program Planning and Coordination, Housing Development Agency

Panellists:
- **Hon. Mmamoloko Kubayi,** Minister of Human Settlements
- **Sandile Luthuli,** CEO, The Social Housing Regulatory Authority
- **Cllr. Charles Nduku,** President, South African Council for the Architectural Profession
- **Bronwyn Williams,** Partner, Flux Trends
- **Dr. Cecil Madell,** Senior Lecturer: School of Architecture, Planning and Geomatics, University of Cape Town

Session E:
Building the Network Industries: Cross-Border Infrastructure/Ports and Logistics

Moderator: Dr. Hubert Joynt, Program Manager: Center of Excellence, Infrastructure South Africa

Panellists:
- **Hon. Sindisiwe Chikunga,** Minister of Transport
- **Reginald Demana,** CEO, SA National Road Agency
- **Peter Vandell,** CEO, NEPAD Business Foundation
- **Xolani Qubeka,** CEO, Small Business Development Institute
- **Yash Ramkolowan,** CEO, DNA Economics
- **Andrew Shaw,** Group Chief Officer: Strategy & Planning, Transnet

15:30 – 17:00

Session F:
State Property Management and Investments

Moderator: JP Van der Merwe, Head of Investment Promotion, WESGRO

Panellists:
- **Hon. Bernice Swarts,** Deputy Minister, Department of Public Works and Infrastructure
- **Panyaza Lesufi,** Premier of Gauteng
- **Siza Sibande,** Head of Property Management & Trading Entity, Department of Public Works and Infrastructure

Session G:
Policy Perspective: Next Generation Digital Communication Infrastructure

Moderator: Bronwyn Williams, Partner, Flux Trends

Panellists:
- **Hon. Philly Mapulane,** Deputy Minister, Department of Communications and Digital Technologies in South Africa
- **Charles Cheng,** Managing Director, Huawei International
- **Darryl Epstein,** Managing Director, Delta Scan
- **Mahlatsi Molokomme,** Head of Strategic Initiatives & Digital Integration (SSA Eastern Europe and Asia), Sustainable Infrastructure Foundation
- **Dietlof Mare,** CEO, MAZIV

Session H:
Policy Perspective: Growing Digital Technologies, Innovation and Construction

Moderator: Tsepiso Makwetla, SABC

Panellists:
- **Zamani Saul,** Premier of the Northern Cape
- **Christopher Campbell,** CEO, Consulting Engineers South Africa
- **Bongani Dladla,** CEO, Construction Industry Development Board SA
- **Lisa Reynolds,** CEO, Green Building Council South Africa
- **Neville Chainee,** Head of Department: Strategy, Program Planning and Coordination, Housing Development Agency

Session I:
Money Matters: PPPs and Blended Financing Models – Funding for Future Infrastructure Investments

Moderator: Clement Manyathela, Radio 702

Panellists:
- **Leila Mokaddem,** Director General: Southern Africa, African Development Bank
- **Thiagaraj Pillay,** Director TBH PPP, Western Cape Government
- **Nina Yose, Head** of Infrastructure, Industrial Development Corporation
- **Nina Yose,** Head of Infrastructure, Industrial Development Corporation
- **Mohale Rakgate,** Chief Investment Officer: Infrastructure Fund
- **Zakhele Mayisa,** Co-Head: Africa Infrastructure Finance, Nedbank

Session J:
Critical Infrastructure Considerations: Sustainability for Future Generation

Moderator: Sekadi Phayane-Shakhane, CEO, SAICE

Panellists:
- **Friedrich Slabbert,** President Elect 2024 & Chair of the Infrastructure Working Group, SAICE
- **Andre Clothier,** President 2024, SAICE
- **Vishaal Lutchman,** Vice President 2024 SAICE
- **Malani Padayachee-**Saman, Member, SAICE
- **Lorato Ntsie,** Student Support and Growing Forward Champion, SAICE

Networking Reception

BREAKOUT SESSIONS

The SIDSSA 2024 featured a strong lineup of Breakout Sessions that involved discussions on water infrastructure, financing, state property management, digital technologies and more. These sessions highlighted the challenges and opportunities faced by South Africa's infrastructure sector, emphasizing themes of support, inclusivity, affordability, accessibility, logistics and innovation.

A session titled Policy Perspective: Investing in Water Infrastructure for Universal Access and in Support of a Strong, Inclusive Economy focused on opportunities to invest in water infrastructure. The construction of water infrastructure projects in South Africa is being spearheaded by the second phase of the R39 billion Lesotho Highlands Water project.

The blend of municipal revenue sources with financing from development finance institutions and commercial finance was highlighted as a requisite to raise fund for bulk infrastructure required for services such as water, sanitation, roads, electricity and solid waste. Improved access to future revenue was unpacked during the Money Matters: Financing Municipal Bulk Infrastructure session.

A breakdown of South Africa's 2024/2025 project pipeline was delivered during a strategic panel discussion, titled Big Infrastructure Wins: Unpacking the Top 12 Project Priorities. South Africa's Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure Sihle Zikalala unpacked the country's recently announced infrastructure priorities for project preparation. The Minister indicated that the objective of the 12 infrastructure priorities is to stimulate job creation, promote economic competitiveness and contribute to broadening economic inclusivity.

During a session titled Policy Perspective: Making Affordable Housing and Infrastructure Accessible for All, a slate of representatives from across South Africa's housing sector examined strategies to accelerate the deployment of affordable housing in the country. It was noted during the session that the expansion of social housing to respond to the gap market is poised to enable easy access to funding while building cohesive and integrated communities.

During the Building the Network Industries: Cross Border Infrastructure/Ports and Logistics session, South African rail, port and pipeline company Transnet showcased its recently published network statement, which details the functions of the infrastructure manager and the contractual agreements for private sector operators. The statement serves as a step towards introducing third-party access to South Africa's rail network.

The symposium featured a breakout session focused on State Property Management and Investments, which focused on how properties maintain their current investment value while carrying value towards the future. The session explored accounting principles, budgeting and expenditure management in South Africa's property sector.

Coordinating efforts to streamline spectrum allocation and licensing across various sectors including fixed mobile, broadcasting, aeronautical and marine communication, research and development and community access, the Policy Perspective: Next Generation Digital Communication Infrastructure session explored sectoral transformation and enhancing digital connectivity in South Africa, particularly in remote and rural areas.

Meanwhile, the structural role of construction and the importance of the processes of its digitalisation were explored during the Policy Perspective: Growing Digital Technologies, Innovation and Construction session. The session sought to strengthen the processes of digitalisation in construction while overcoming the lack of innovation in other, related sectors.

As South Africa invites investment in large-scale infrastructure projects, blended financing and public-private partnerships (PPPs) have emerged as viable solutions to mobilise private participation in projects. As such, the Money Matters: PPPs and Blended Financing Models – Funding for Future Infrastructure Investments session underscored the role capital-raising solutions play in South Africa.

The South African Institution on Civil Engineering examined considerations on how to improve the sustainability and performance of infrastructure development in the country. Members of the industry body highlighted a focus on maintenance, greater responsiveness from role-players and connectivity as key aspects to improving the deployment of critical infrastructure during a session titled Critical Infrastructure Considerations: Sustainability for Future Generations.

Sustainable Infrastructure Development Symposium 2024

Explore Opportunities for Partnership with the UK

The UK is committed to supporting the delivery of infrastructure projects which drive economic growth and generate benefits for communities around the world. Central to our approach is building local capability - working with local supply chains to deliver climate-resilient infrastructure fit for the future.

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BRITAIN & NORTHERN IRELAND

Unlock the potential of doing business with the UK

UK Infrastructure Partnerships

Discover more about the UK's work and commitment globally towards sustainable development.

UK Export Finance

As the UK's Export Credit Agency with around £4-£5 billion Market Risk Appetite for South Africa, UKEF is well positioned to support South Africa in its infrastructure structure projects and rollout.

UK Construction Book

UK Government's approach on sourcing and contracting public works projects and programmes.

Find out about the UK's industry players

UK Industry's World Class Expertise

IE:UK provides solutions for complex, large infrastructure projects overseas by providing a Team UK consortium offer. Find out more.

British International Investment

Learn about the UK's Development Finance Institution and impact investor - investing in Africa, Asia and the Caribbean.

UK Government

STAKEHOLDER DINNER

Hosted by:
H.E. Paul Mashatile, Deputy President, South Africa
Hon. Sihle Zikalala, Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure, South Africa

The SIDSSA 2024 Stakeholder Dinner featured a keynote address by South Africa's Deputy President Paul Mashatile where he showcased the country's long-term plan for infrastructure development, reiterating the government's commitment to reaching 5.5% year-on-year economic growth.

During the Stakeholder Dinner, Deputy President Paul Mashatile announced that the country currently has R233 billion worth of infrastructure projects currently in construction. It was noted that R170 billion of the total amount is in the procurement phase while R10 billion has been spent on the completion of projects.

DRIVING SUSTAINABLE INFRASTRUCTURE DEVELOPMENT: INSIGHTS FROM SIDSSA 2024

The Development Bank of Southern African (DBSA), participated in the Sustainable Infrastructure Development Symposium South Africa (SIDSSA) 2024 from 17 to 19 March in Cape Town. The Bank engaged in robust discussions with the Minister of Public Works amongst other stakeholders.

The DBSA was also part of thought-provoking panels which delved into the critical role of development finance institutions and multilateral banks in delivering strategic large-scale projects.

The pivotal role of the DBSA and local Development Finance Institutions, particularly in providing project preparation support for specific Strategic Infrastructure Projects (SIP) was key to these conversations.

The Bank emphasised the significance of meticulous project preparation, highlighting the key components, including policy assessment, sponsor capability, infrastructure sustainability amidst climate change impacts, and stakeholder management and underscored the relevance of blended finance models as a means to mitigate fiscal constraints, offering insights into credit enhancement instruments and the collaborative efforts of the state, development finance institutions, and the private sector to ensure the bankability of infrastructure assets.

The DBSA are excited about the potential for leveraging these strategies to drive impactful and sustainable development initiatives and are proud to have been part of these critical discussions and solving for innovative solutions for sustainable infrastructure development to build Africa's prosperity.

QUOTES

"This is a valuable platform to enable us to have an introspective look at the opportunities that we have. Investment in infrastructure is central to our development goals. We are a developing country, and therefore, have identified infrastructure as one of those areas which will become a flywheel for generating growth in our economy. This symposium enables us to close the infrastructure investment gap in our country."

Cyril Ramaphosa, President of the Republic of South Africa

"Since the launch of Infrastructure South Africa, we have been able to unlock more than 195 licenses, permits and approvals within 47 projects alone. South Africa established the Infrastructure Fund to unlock more private investment in the infrastructure pipeline using a variety of blended financing tools. So far, 13 mega blended finance projects or programmes have been approved to date."

Sihle Zikalala, Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure of the Republic of South Africa

"Our main role for the continent is to ensure that we invest in critical infrastructure so that we put in the building blocks that ensure that our nations prosper and that we grow together."

Patricia de Lille, Minister of Tourism, South Africa

"We are expected to provide an enabling environment for the movement of freight and people, which calls for a harmonisation of our services and implementation of a favourable regulatory framework."

Sindisiwe Chikunga, Minister of Transport, South Africa

"Today, this symposium marks a very great programme that we are starting, looking at that in infrastructure we are now faced with climate change and the environment and its impact on South Africa. Out of this symposium, we need to share ideas in terms of how we take infrastructure to greater heights. We are looking at infrastructure to grow and stimulate the economy of South Africa."

Bernice Swartz, Deputy Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure

"By facilitating the economic reforms, which are aimed at accelerating and facilitating investment, trade facilitation and job growth, we are encouraged by a firm commitment by the leaders who are present here today. Such commitment is poised to drive a prosperous Africa."

Kenny Morolong, Deputy Minister in the Presidency, South Africa

"Adopting next generation technologies is vital to take advantage of our modern digital environment in South Africa. In recent years, South Africa has recognised the importance of keeping up with the digital age. As a continent experiencing rapid population growth, we must embrace digital infrastructure."

Philly Mapulane, Deputy Minister of Communications and Digital Technologies

"We recognize the realisation that we are living in interesting times and we have to ensure we have a sustainable future. You can't build a sustainable future when your infrastructure is done in isolation to a number of issues."

Mxolisi Dukwana, Premier of the Free State Province

"KwaZulu-Natal is a coastal province, or a port province, and as a result of that, the whole country's economy relies on the efficiencies of our port, of our rail network and of our aviation network for the betterment of the economy."

Nomusa Dube-Ncube, Premier of KwaZulu-Natal

"We have been established as Infrastructure South Africa as a bespoke infrastructure development agency in the country. The government was responding to several challenges with respect to growing the infrastructure project pipeline, closing the infrastructure investment gap and ensuring there is a robust infrastructure project pipeline in the country."

Mameetse Masemola, Acting Head, Infrastructure South Africa

"We have come to share with you, to learn with you and to communicate with you. We find that rapid technological advancement is significant and cannot be overstated. As we experience the competitiveness of the digital age, it is imperative that our digital infrastructure is able to meet the demands of an ever-changing landscape."

Sekou M. Kromah, Minister of Posts and Telecommunications, Liberia

"When we talk about infrastructure, infrastructure is the backbone of our economy. Unfortunately, due to climate change, it is now exposed. Something has to be done to ensure our infrastructure is sustainable."

Chief Ndlaluhlaza Ndwandwe, Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure, Eswatini

"As much as our economy is dependent on South Africa, we are determined to drive infrastructure to supply the Republic with water through our Lesotho highlands water project, which has just started its second phase."

Lebona Lephema, Minister of Local Government, Chieftainship, Home Affairs and Police, Lesotho

"The way our country operates is very different because of the sanctions imposed on us, which makes the country unable to access funding from the World Bank, IMF and all other international institutions. So, you find that everything we do is very different from the rest of the world, because of the sanctions."

Winston Chitando, Minister of Local Government and Public Works, Zimbabwe

"Our continent is a precious continent and we – in Seychelles – look up to South Africa to inspire us to build up our infrastructure development."

Billy Rangasamy, Minister of Land and Housing, Seychelles

"The heads of infrastructure departments must always gather to discuss and help other countries that haven't been developed yet."

Don Pascual Ondo Nze Oyana, Minister of Public Works, Housing and Town Planning, Equatorial Guinea

CLOSING STATEMENT

The SIDSSA 2024 convened from March 17-19, drawing insight into the progress made to transform the economy through infrastructure development. The platform has been pivotal for uniting public and private sectors and driving investment in strategic projects. During the symposium, South Africa's President Cyril Ramaphosa called for private-led investment in infrastructure development while highlighting the government's efforts to streamline and implement regulatory reforms in the sector.

The launch of 12 major infrastructure projects as well as South Africa's Construction Book are poised to contribute significantly to the country's industrialisation, local content creation and socioeconomic development. South Africa's long-term plan for achieving inclusive growth, prosperity and improvement in the quality of life for the country's citizens took centre stage at SIDSSA 2024, with the President's participation guaranteed to gazette opportunities for investing in infrastructure for the benefit of all stakeholders.

The symposium featured ten Breakout Sessions spanning various sectors of South Africa's infrastructure industry, including water infrastructure, financing, project preparation, housing, network industries, property management, digital communication and technologies, blended financing and sustainability.

A Masterclass led by South Africa's Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure Sihle Zikalala featured the launch of Cape Town's 2023 Infrastructure Report as well as a dedicated panel session that called on investors and role-players to support an infrastructure-led economic recovery plan in the country. Meanwhile, a Leaders Meeting convened South African and regional ministers to pinpoint key infrastructure priorities both within the country and across the continent.

SIDSSA 2024 was organised by the Investment and Infrastructure Office under the Presidency, in collaboration with the Association of African Exhibition Organisers. The National African Bank Federation for the Building Industry served as an association partner, while the Development Bank of Southern Africa was the official sponsor of the event.

ABOUT THE ORGANISERS

Infrastructure South Africa

Infrastructure South Africa is an infrastructure centre of excellence and is established as a single point of entry for infrastructure planning, management and delivery. Infrastructure South Africa is a catalyst for closing the infrastructure investment gap and meeting the infrastructure target set out in the National Development Plan and provides best practices in project preparation, leadership on infrastructure planning and technical and financial support for nationally prioritised infrastructure projects and programmes.

The Association of African Exhibition Organisers

The Association of African Exhibition Organisers (AAXO) is committed to promoting the African exhibitions industry, encouraging businesses to invest and participate in exhibitions, affording our members the tools and resources for successful exhibition management and encouraging world-class industry standards. This dedication is evident in AAXO's commitment to linking organisers to a network of suppliers and opportunities to ensure growth and inclusivity continentally.

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Sustainable Infrastructure Development Symposium South Africa (SIDSSA) 2024: Unpacking South Africa's Top 12 Infrastructure Priorities

By / March 20, 2024 / APO, Media

South Africa's Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure Sihle Zikalala unpacked the country's 2024/2025 infrastructure priorities and project pipeline during a panel session at the Sustainable Infrastructure Development Symposium South Africa (SIDSSA) 2024 in Cape Town on Tuesday.

According to Minister Zikalala, the country's top 12 infrastructure priorities seek to stimulate job creation, promote economic competitiveness and contribute to broadening economic inclusivity.

"We announced the 12 priority projects today and it's important to give a background as to how we arrived at this priority list. We want projects that will contribute to higher GDP impact, but at the same time, ensure export and embrace the green economy," he stated.

Taking place on March 17-19 at the Century City Conference Center, SIDSSA brings together key stakeholders in South Africa and across the continent with the aim of driving infrastructure development. SIDSSA 2024 serves as a crucial platform for discussions and partnerships in the infrastructure investment landscape, with a focus on accelerating economic activity through strategic infrastructure plans. Energy Capital&Power – the leading investment platform for the African energy sector – is a media partner for this important platform. For more information, visit https://SIDSSA.org.za/.

Media Partners Upcoming Events

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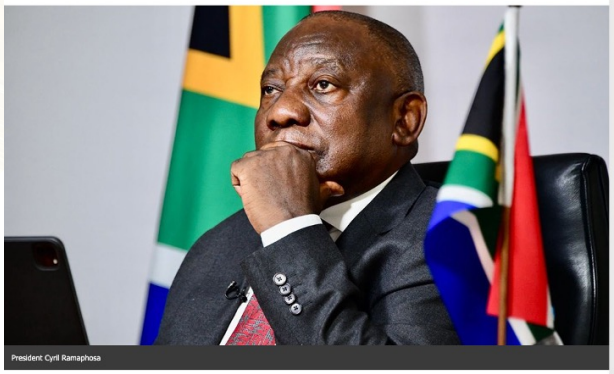
President Cyril Ramaphosa

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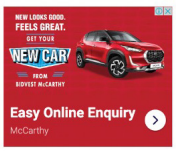

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African Ministers Discuss Infrastructure Cooperation at Sustainable Infrastructure Development Symposium (SIDSSA) Leaders Meeting

South African and regional ministers convened to pinpoint key infrastructure priorities both within South Africa and across the continent during a Leaders Meeting at the Sustainable Infrastructure Development Symposium (SIDSSA) 2024 on March 18 in Cape Town. The discussion, which was led by South Africa's Minister of Public Works and Infrastructure Sihle Zikalala, underscored the [...]

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Government stakeholders shared South Africa's infrastructure investment milestones and future plans during an exclusive media briefing on Monday

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President Cyril Ramaphosa calls to drive investment in infrastructure at SIDSSA 2024

Wed, Mar 20, 2024
By editor
3 MIN READ

FOREIGN

THE South African President Cyril Ramaphosa called for private-led investment in infrastructure development at the 2024 edition of the Sustainable Infrastructure Development Symposium of South Africa, SIDSSA, on in Cape Town on Tuesday.

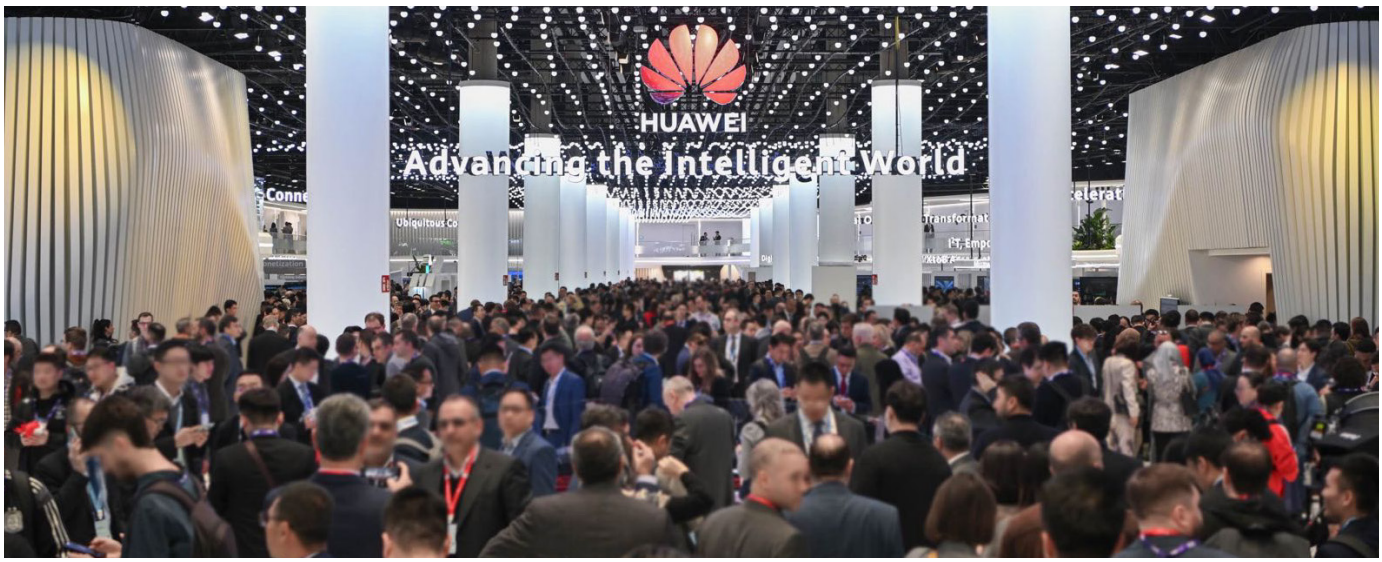
"It is estimated that to achieve our infrastructure goals, we need almost R4.8 trillion to address the challenges we face as a country. We need that from both the public sector and the private sector – from a much larger extent," stated President Ramaphosa.

Taking place on March 17-19 at the Century City Conference Center, SIDSSA brings together key stakeholders in South Africa and across the continent with the aim of driving infrastructure development. SIDSSA 2024 serves as a crucial platform for discussions and partnerships in the infrastructure investment landscape, with a focus on accelerating economic activity through strategic infrastructure plans. Energy Capital & Power – the leading investment platform for the African energy sector – is a media partner for this important platform.

The South African government has been working to streamline its infrastructure sector and attract investment in strategic projects. Regulatory reforms, according to President Ramaphosa, include "the amendment within our own realm of the Division of Revenue Act, to enable provincial government to use their provincial grants to crowd in the private sector to finance large-scale infrastructure, and to open up opportunities for the private sector to work alongside government to create revenue [illegible]ating projects."

Huawei Advances Intelligence, Launches 5.5G and Excels at Innovation

Huawei aims to promote the intelligent digital transformation across industries, build a thriving industry ecosystem, accelerate the positive business cycle of 5G, and prepare for the upcoming 5.5G era.



Huawei Exhibition stand at MWC 2024

Huawei, which was named Best Network Vendor in South Africa by MyBroadband Magazine, has once again demonstrated its prowess at the recently concluded MWC Barcelona 2024. It did so by highlighting its key focus on business success in the 5G era and industry intelligence transformation. Huawei also bagged several GSMA Glomo Awards at the ICT showcase held in Barcelona.

Through the course of the event, Huawei released a host of innovative solutions and infrastructure to mobile network operators looking to reap the benefits of commercial 5 and 5.5G. The products and solutions it launched at the annual showcase include:

- The world's first 5.5G Intelligent Core Network, which will enable mobile network operators to better monetise different aspects of their mobile broadband networks and help them achieve better network stability and efficiency.

- Three innovative all-optical products to open up F5.5G for commercial use. These included the industry's first DC-oriented OTN product, OptiX OSN 9800 K36; the industry's first intelligent OLT product, OptiXaccess MA5800T; and the industry's first FTTR+X product, iFTTR OptiXstar F50 for ultra-broadband backbone, 10G access, and all-optical smart home scenarios. The three innovative products help operators build an F5.5G all-optical target network and accelerate the development of 10G ultra-broadband, together opening up the commercial use of F5.5G.

- A wide range of Net5.5G solutions to inspire new growth of carriers. The four solutions are tailored to Net5.5G, covering mobile backhaul, enterprise campus, converged transport, and data centre networks, and are aimed at helping carriers achieve key capabilities such as ubiquitous 10 Gbps access, 400GE converged transport, hyper-converged data centres, and network autonomy and self-optimisation.

Huawei additionally unveiled eight innovation practices to help operators with the launch of their commercial 5.5G. These

include antenna and network band upgrades, using "0 Bit 0 Watt" 5.5G series equipment, signal direct injection feeding (SDIF) to all antennas, and the incorporation of large communication models and RAN digital twin systems to support L4 network intelligence.

In his keynote, Li Peng, Huawei's Corporate Senior Vice President and President of ICT Sales & Service underscored the opportunities that 5.5G offers to operators as well as those that will be open to the ICT industry in an intelligent world.

"We're rapidly approaching an intelligent world," he said. "As the demands on networks have increased, 5.5G has become a key step on the path to the intelligent world. 5.5G is expected to enter commercial use in 2024. So, let's build today's networks for tomorrow's applications to advance the intelligent world."

According to Li, making the most of the opportunities presented by this intelligent world will require significant network improvements, including uplink ultra-broadband, real-time broadband communication, and full-scenario IoT. These requirements have driven the rapid evolution to 5.5G which will be able to enable innovative application scenarios and business models. By 2030, the intelligent economy is expected to be worth more than 18.8 trillion dollars, bringing a new wave of opportunities for the industry.

"5.5G is entering commercial use in 2024, and as 5.5G, AI, and cloud converge, carriers can unlock the potential of new applications and capabilities," he added.

He went on to say that carriers around the world should focus on high-quality networking, multi-dimensional monetisation, emerging services, and generative AI to grasp these opportunities.

Huawei's successful track record of innovation was further reflected in the awards it received at MWC, Huawei took home several awards, including Best Mobile Network Infrastructure for its MetaAAU product, Best Mobile Technology Breakthrough for its FDD Beamforming Series, the GSMA Foundry Excellence Award, Best Network Software Breakthrough, and the 5G Industry Challenge Award.

About Huawei

Founded in 1987, Huawei is a leading global provider of information and communications technology (ICT) infrastructure and smart devices. We have 207,000 employees and operate in over 170 countries and regions, serving more than three billion people around the world. We are committed to bringing digital to every person, home and organisation for a fully connected, intelligent world.

Huawei values research and innovation. In 2023, the company invested $22.77 billion back into R&D, which accounted for 23.4% of its annual revenue.

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